This is the quickest route but perhaps not the cheapest. The passage money is high. I think I could go to England and back in six months well, and have upwards of three months perhaps four in England. It would not do to be more than six months away if I wanted to keep my place here. I should then, (in case I stayed away more than six months) perhaps loose the villages and much injure my prospects.

August 7th. The courier is in from Tehran and goes on towards Erzeroom, to day in answer to my letter to Col Sheil, for leave to go home, I give you the following extract from his letter which is all he writes on the subject. "Hadji Meerza Agasi has given a positive refusal to your departure from Persia before the arrival of your brother." This being the case I have no other alternative except one which I am sure neither you nor my dear Mother would wish me to take advantage of. That of running away. Because this would be dishonourable. And in every situation in which I have been placed, I have never forgot that I am your son and I have endeavoured never to do any thing which might bring disgrace on my dear Father and my dear Mother. Nothing would be easier than for me to quit the country without leave. I am often absent from Tabreez ten or fifteen days at a time, and thirty-six hours would carry me over the frontier. My never having been put in prison, I owe certainly to the fact of people having placed confidence in me. And if the feeling of never doing anything to bring disgrace on our family, did not prevent my acting wrong, ought not the confidence thus placed in me to have the same effect. When in 1840 I was at Ispahan, had either the Shah or his prime minister treated me with indignity, the whole court and camp, and all the foreign missions there, would have exclaimed against this proceeding, and most likely have prevented it. There was then neither Envoy or Consul in the country to protect me — All political relations between the countries were broken off. I owed my protection to my character and to that only. How careful then ought I be to keep that character unsullied. Adieu my dear father, God bless you and preserve you."[113]

[EDWARD BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Kara Chibuk, in the district of Maranghd, October 18, 1847*

I a few days ago received a letter from my cousin Foljambe informing me of my poor Mothers death.[114] O my dear Father, by my own grief, I can in some measure imagine what your affliction must have been. I never felt my absence

[113] Edward now seems to have resigned himself to the prospect of remaining in Persia for the rest of his life.

[114] August, 1847.

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